

Chapter 6

A Digital Library for Researchers, Scientists, and Scholars: Mendeley Desktop Application

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ABSTRACT

This chapter discusses the application of Mendeley desktop in academic and research libraries. The features of Mendeley were used to justify it as a digital library for researchers, scientists, and scholars. The importance of Mendeley desktop application as a digital library was also compared with a traditional library. This chapter should thus enable anyone without prior knowledge of Mendeley to effectively utilise it as a digital library as it provides an extensive guide on how to work with the Mendeley Application to perform various tasks.

INTRODUCTION

Library remains an avenue for sourcing information and performing other activities such as reading, studying, writing, and researching. Its extensive use by individuals of all categories and fields makes it one of the most critical places knowledge seekers should not overlook. The library can be used across different levels of education. A library is a collection of resources, books, or media readily available. It stores up-to-date information that suits the demands of different users daily. A physical or virtual library gives physical or digital access to available resources in hard copies or electronic form. The collection in a library may comprise printed and non-printed resources stored in a bibliographic database.

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A Digital Library for Researchers, Scientists, and Scholars

Over the years, development in Information and Communication Technology, especially the Internet, has brought various electronic tools and databases that changed how information is collected, processed, stored, and retrieved. Consequently, attention is gradually shifting from traditional to electronic libraries for speedy and accurate access to information. One of such innovations shaping the way scholarly materials are organised, classified and retrieved is the Mendeley Desktop Application (hereafter MDA). This chapter discusses the Mendeley application as a digital and portable library for researchers, scientists and scholars. The chapter describes the application's features and aims to guide readers to use the application effectively. The authors ensured that this chapter was presented to promote understanding among young and experienced readers.

Therefore, at the end of reading this chapter, readers should be able to: describe the MDA; identify/mention the various features of the MDA; electronically catalogue books and research articles using the MDA; use it for citing and referencing articles in Microsoft word; highlight the importance of MDA to scholars, researchers and scientists.

OVERVIEW OF A DIGITAL LIBRARY

As days pass, innovations keep emerging in all fields of man's endeavours. Thus, Library and Information Science as a discipline is not left out due to the high demand for quick and easy access to books, journal articles and other information sources. In time past, researchers, scholars and scientists relied on the physical/traditional library to source relevant knowledge and information. Along the line, many scholars faced the challenge of travelling distance locations in search of scholarly literature. Fortunately, this challenge was bridged through the advent of the Internet and electronic/digital databases. The Internet is a platform that allows individuals to communicate/disseminate research ideas and findings electronically without having to meet themselves or travel across a long distance. Although the Internet made the storing and retrieval of information accessible, not many people have benefited from the wealth of the Internet. This is because many people lack Internet access, especially in Africa and developing nations (Abdulqadir & Asongu, 2022; Mojapelo, 2020; Owan et al., 2021, 2022; Oyedemi, 2015; Sambuli, 2016). Without internet access, there will be difficulty gathering scholarly materials, especially at the convenience of one's location.

Over two decades ago, accessing digital information was only possible by saving the materials/books on a computer disk or removable disks such as CD-ROM, floppy disks, etc. However, there is poor maximisation of cataloguing skills/tools when accessing files from such storage devices. Thus, these media do not constitute a digital library. A digital library should contain appropriately arranged materials (catalogue) to optimise easy access to information. Cataloguing is a demanding task performed by librarians to ensure that materials are not mixed up. Cataloguing aims to make sure that materials are timely and quickly sourced. The arrangement of materials (including books, journal articles, magazines, etc.) uses several classification indicators. For instance, books can be classified based on, but not limited to, the field, author(s), publisher(s) and year of publication. This means that anywhere materials are saved without appropriate arrangement and classification, such media cannot be referred to as a library. For a platform to be considered a library, it must possess many features (such as proper management of materials, easy accessibility, location of indexed materials, etc.), just like traditional libraries.

Digital libraries, therefore, are electronic databases devoted to producing and maintaining e-collections without requiring end-users to buy the contents they wish to retrieve (Cordón-García et al., 2013). The

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term “digital library” refers to electronic information collections that include vast and diversified digital content repositories that many geographically dispersed users may retrieve (Khiste et al., 2018). Using computer networks and the Internet, anybody with access to a network or a digital library may easily access a wide variety of electronic information resources stored inside the system (Omotayo & Haliru, 2020). Córdón-García and his colleagues also added that these libraries are primarily filled with reposit-ed knowledge that is freely accessible over the Web. They are notable for the simplicity with which collections may be accessed, the networking opportunities they provide, and the worldwide availability of their contents.

Digital libraries are also referred to as a new kind of library that leverages current information technology to digitalise materials and services (Li et al., 2019). It is common for the functionality of a digital library platform to vary depending on what step of processing is taking place at that time (Zhang et al., 2015). This means that library information technology may be separated into system support, content organisation and user service technologies (Anuradha, 2015). In this chapter, we define a digital library as a collection of books, journal articles, audio, and videos available on the Internet and accessible through computers and smartphones. Digital databases such as Google Scholar and Scopus possess features like a digital library; they are not digital libraries because they are not flexible. For instance, one cannot influence the arrangement of books or materials based on his preferences. Those databases have been customised and can only be modified by the programme developers. Besides, one cannot access the database without Internet and institutional access. Examples of digital libraries include Project Gutenberg, World Digital Library, European digital library, Universal Digital Library, Open Library, Internet Archive, etc. Although the sites have been termed digital libraries, they can only be accessed when there is internet access. Information retrieval would always be a challenge in places with poor internet access.

Evolution and Trends in Digital Libraries

The notion of a digital library may be traced back to the early stages of the electronic library. Christian (1975) was the first to suggest an electronic library, which was further described in 1984 as an institution that gives access to knowledge and uses electronic technology to expand and manage information resources (Dowlin, 1984). Digital libraries first appeared in the early 1990s, although they were preceded by the inspirational concepts of creative thinkers and many decades of active progress in information technology (Xie & Matusiak, 2016). For decades, academic research libraries have been digitising and maintaining online collections to make collections more accessible. While online discovery and access to archive information have improved, academics have mainly utilised digital collections in the same way: scrolling through pages of text, photos, maps, and historical documents (Wittmann et al., 2019).

Digital libraries are a by-product of advances in information technology, particularly the Internet. Some academics believe that information technology has pushed the library beyond its conventional stage into library automation. The digital library will continue to emerge more innovatively in the future due to the rapid development of information civilisation (Wang, 2021). Researchers are increasingly using the notion of “collections as data” to understand better our digital collections and the data they include (Padilla, 2018).

Despite their numerous challenges and constraints, digital libraries have kept up with the speed of technological advancement. All the buzzwords in IT are pursued by today’s libraries, from cloud computing, resource finding, Big Data, and the Internet of things to Blockchain Technology (Wei & Deming, 2015). Data resources are multiplying exponentially in the current age of Big Data, but so is the diffi-

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culty of extracting the valuable information consumers want. Data processing is becoming much more complicated. Resource service for digital libraries is now required since conventional data processing technology has evident flaws (Dongxing et al., 2011). A better way of building and managing electronic libraries is to improve existing methods, such as data analysis, decision-making, semantics, and data management and presentation technologies such as visualisation (Li et al., 2019). This requires that digital libraries constantly improve their use of new technologies and adjust to current trends and innovations.

Digital Library Software

Different types of digital library software enable users to access information speedily. Examples include Ampletrails Library, BiblioteQ, CONTENTdm, DigiTool, DSpace, EPrints, Greenstone, Invenio, KOHA, Marvel Soft Library Management System, Mintbook, Mnesys, My Library by Solver Software, Omeka, OPALS, ORI-OAI, PMB and Yoolib (Andro et al., 2012). These programmes manage collections of documents, permanent archiving, document identification through unique URLs, metadata structure management and digital reconstruction of documents. Other functions of these programmes include access control based on the IP address, user registration, and granting different rights to administrators, metadata producers, digital documents producers and users. Furthermore, digital library software can be used for collaborative indexing, digital document annotation, commenting on documents and building libraries by users.

Working with digital library software has several advantages since they offer quick and broad access to information. They can be used for the logical arrangement of literature materials and to produce various reports. They provide timely access to information and make data retrieval easy. They can be used to host a large volume of content and offer a variety of ways for information search. They improve the oversight of bibliographical sources and are not bound by geography or other distance-related limitations. According to Andro et al. (2012), choosing which software to use is dependent on factors such as whether the document is old or new and whether the software is open-source (e.g., DSpace, EPrints, Greenstone, Invenio, Omeka, ORI-OAI, KOHA, BiblioteQ, OPALS and PMB) or proprietary (e.g., Ampletrails Library, CONTENTdm, DigiTool, Marvel Soft Library Management System, Mnesys, Mintbook My Library, Yoolib). For instance, some programmes such as CONTENTdm, DigiTool, Greenstone, Mnesys, Omeka and Yoolib are well-suited for managing old documents. In contrast, others such as DSpace, EPrints, Invenio, and ORI-OAI are better for newer documents.

However, besides the traditional and popularly-discussed digital library programmes, other electronic databases (such as Web of Science, Scopus, ERIC, Proquest etc.) and pre-print servers (such as arXiv, Research Square, AAS Open arXiv, AfricArXiv, bioRxiv, EdArXiv etc.) possess attributes almost qualifiable as digital libraries. Nevertheless, citation/referencing tools such as Zotero, EndNote, and Mendeley possess attributes that qualify them as digital libraries. However, few scholars have conceived and appreciated their use beyond citation and referencing. Other scholars have been attracted to the subject of Mendeley but focused more on its use as a social/networking media (Holt Zaugg et al., 2011; MacMillan, 2012). Some scholars have also been interested in comparing the effectiveness of Mendeley with that of other citation managers such as Zotero, RefWorks and Endnote (Bhardwaj, 2017; Ivey & Crum, 2018; Kratochvíl, 2017). Some scholars have considered the Mendeley citation and read count (Kolahi et al., 2020; Maflahi & Thelwall, 2018; Thelwall, 2017) without focusing on the MDA. The MDA is different from Mendeley social network. Subsequent sections of this chapter discuss MDA as a digital library and offer a practical guide to enable readers to use it in managing library resources.

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THE MENDELEY DESKTOP APPLICATION: ALL YOU NEED TO KNOW

Mendeley is a free bibliographic reference management application and an academic social network for scholars and scientists. As a citation manager (like EndNote, RefWorks or Zotero), it allows users to collect and save citations from many sources, extract bibliographic information and create accurate in-text citations and references. As a sophisticated social networking platform, Mendeley allows users to collaborate and discover resources utilising Web 2.0 features (MacMillan, 2012). The programme was named after biologist Grigor Mendel and chemist Dmitri Mendeleyev (Hicks, 2011). It was founded in 2007, and its beta version was later released in 2008 (Mendeley, 2021). Mendeley is now owned by Elsevier, having been purchased in 2013. There are two types of Mendeley citation managers - the Desktop Application and the Reference Manager. Both are often synchronised for cloud backup, making it simple for users to annotate and organise documents with easy accessibility. The application is free and can be downloaded from its website (www.mendeley.com). The capabilities of Mendeley Desktop and Mendeley Web are maximised when employed in conjunction since their characteristics complement one another (Zhang, 2012). MDA has a word processor plugin that allows authors to cite consulted articles with just a button click. The citation styles found in Mendeley's reference management software include the American Medical Association (AMA), Chicago Manual of Style, IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers), American Political Science Association (APSA), American Psychological Association (APA), National Library of Medicine (NLM), American Sociological Association (ASA), Harvard, Nature, Modern Humanities Research Association (MHRA), Modern Language Association (MLA) and Vancouver (Iskandar & Patak, 2019). Using Mendeley to prepare citations and references saves time and enables scholars to flexibly insert bibliographies (Orhan & Ozkan, 2014).

Features of the Mendeley Desktop

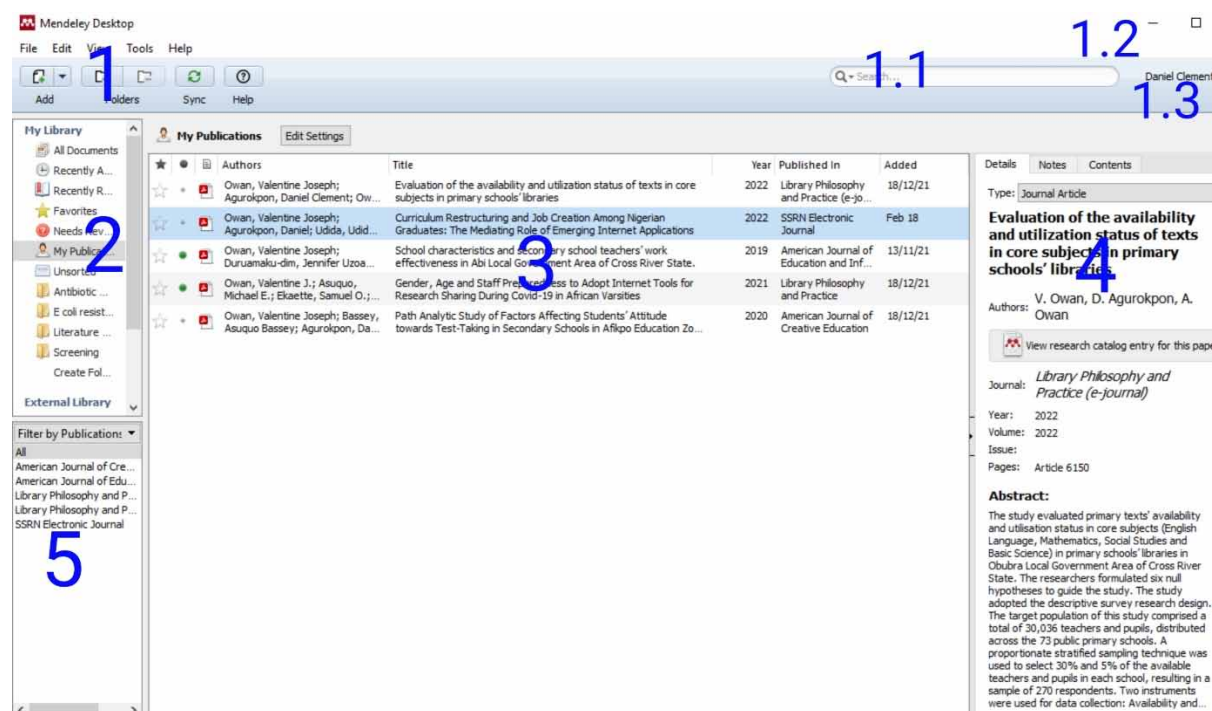
The MDA has several features, making it flexible and user friendly. It has a powerful cataloguing feature and work-friendly interface. This means that users do not need to become computer wizards before using the application. The application's main interface is labelled 1-5 in Figure 1. Label 1 represents the *Menu Bar*. All installation plugins can be found in the tools tab under the *Menu bar*. Label number 2 represents the *library's bookshelf*, where all materials such as books and journal articles are uploaded/imported and accessed. Label 3 simulates a *Desk* in a traditional library where collections from a folder are kept for easy perusal. Clicking on any folder on the bookshelf makes all the documents in that folder appear on the desk (Labelled 3).

To read any document on the desk, the reader must double click on the file. The desk also has cataloguing features that simplify searching for a particular document. Labelled 4 is precisely the place to find all the *Metadata* (i.e., name(s) of the author(s), journal, publication date, abstract, etc.) of a document. Another important menu is the section labelled 5. This section is termed the library *Catalogue* because it is where all the materials on the bookshelf can be quickly sorted based on the author's name, document keywords, publication title or the publishers. Note that the bookshelf and the *Catalogue* work together. It is only the Shelf (folder) you click that the cataloguing filter will apply (except if you click on the "all documents folder").

There is also a powerful *search feature* (labelled 1.1), where keywords are entered to locate documents like search engines and digital databases. The search is folder sensitive, implying that only materials on a working folder can be located during the search. The only exception is when working on the "all

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Figure 1. The main user interface of Mendeley desktop application



document folder” that the keywords can locate materials from any location, so long as the search string matches the keywords entered. The *tools* (label 1.2) are the control buttons to minimise, maximise or close the application. Label 1.3 shows the user account created at *Mendeley web*. The Mendeley programme is so flexible that a user can easily log into another computer using his login details to automatically retrieve all documents in his library even with a computer change.

Working with Mendeley Application

To start working with the Mendeley Application, users must add documents to their libraries. This works in the same way as a traditional library, where a collection of library resources is acquired and classified for easy retrieval and use. There are more than three ways to add files to Mendeley Desktop. Adding a specific file, a folder in your computer, importing from the Web as RIS, BibTeX, or EndNote XML file format. Users can also add files manually by imputing the Metadata of the documents. You can use a digital object identifier (DOI) to extract the document’s information by adding documents manually. When adding a document to your computer, click on the file or folder. Mendeley will take you to your file explorer; you will select the folder containing the document you wish to add to the library. Once you have located the file, click on the file and click on open (which can be found at the base left corner). The file will automatically be added to the folder on the bookshelf. If you want to add a file from the Web, you can download the file as an *RIS* or a *BibTeX* and then open it with Mendeley Desktop.

You can also add documents using the “*Web Importer*” located in the menu bar. The file metadata will automatically be added. However, the PDF file will not be added; thus, you cannot read the document’s

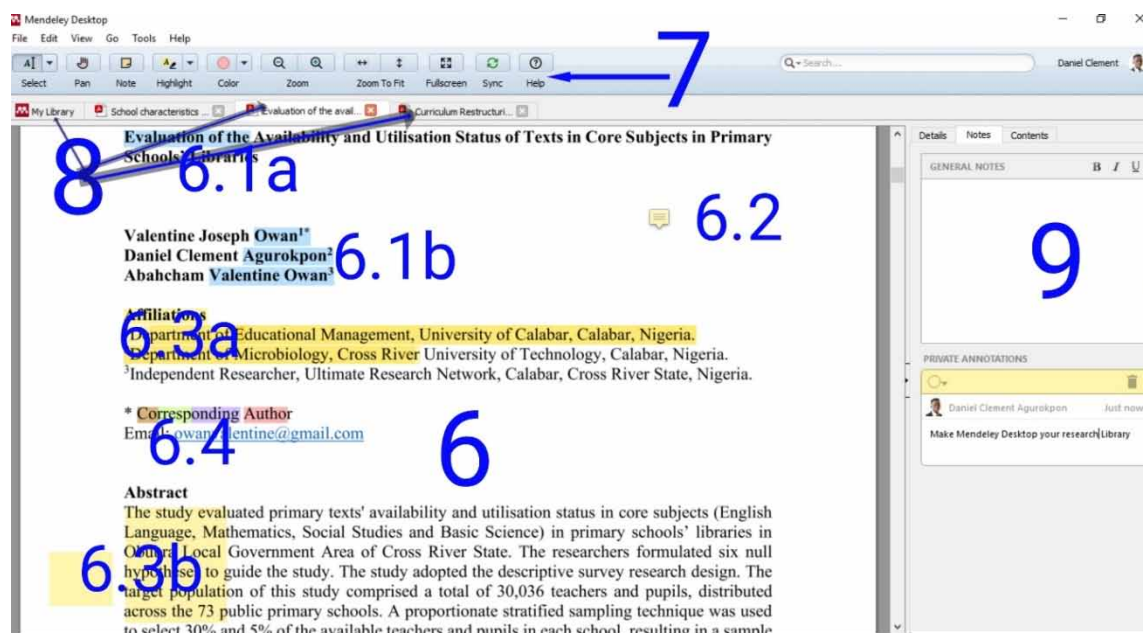
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main text unless you click on “*view research catalogue entry for this paper*”, which can be found in Label 4 (see Fig 1). At the time of writing (version 1.19.8), files in .doc or .docx format cannot be read using the Mendeley Desktop application, but they can be added to Mendeley. These types of files can be opened using the programs designed for them (e.g., Microsoft Word) based on a call from Mendeley. Word documents in Mendeley can automatically be opened using Microsoft Word even though the document is clicked in Mendeley. After adding the file(s) or folder, click on the sync button as shown in Label 1 (see fig. 1). Files with the same Metadata previously added to other authors’ libraries are often updated automatically. This means a high chance of having already updated Metadata provided by co-authors or other previous users. A search tool beside the DOI section can track the document’s Metadata from the CrossRef database. After importing all documents, you can access them on the bookshelf (labelled 3 in Fig 1). Double-click on the desired file to open the document’s content (see label 6 in figure 2). Some tools could be used to perform any operation on the opened text. The menu for these tools has been tagged number 7 with an arrow pointing at the tools. The tools include the *select*, *pan*, *note*, *highlight*, *colour*, *zoom*, *zoom to fit*, *sync* and *help tools*. These tools are generally valuable for marking a document, identifying essential areas in a document and making comments that can aid in the subsequent studying of the file. The operational outcome of the tools is shown with labels in figure 2. First is the select text tools. The *select text* tool is used for highlighting and copying text. The tool contains two sub-tools; the first is used to highlight text following paragraphs (Labelled 6.1a in Fig2), while the other is used to highlight text in block irrespective of the position of the text, as shown in Label 6.1b. The next is the *pan* (hand tool) which can be termed the “*returning tool*.” After activating other tools, they will still function even when you do not want to use them. When using the *pan tool*, you can only scroll through the text without performing any operation.

The *note tool* is used to make notes while reading through the document. They help make critical comments to enable users to remember essential information after reading the document’s main text. The note (labelled 6.2) can be kept anywhere in the document interface (Label 6). Interestingly, all notes can be found at the right of the interface labelled 9. In the box (labelled 9), general notes on the document can also be documented. The *highlight tool* is similar to the select text tool on the tools. This is because both can be used to copy text. The unique feature of the *highlight tool* is that all highlighted text remains coloured. Unlike the *select tool*, you need to pin it before it remains in the interface. Another exciting aspect is that the second sub-tool in highlight can mark any part of a document (shapes, blank space, text, etc.) labelled 6.3a and 6.3b for the two sub-tools. While working with both the highlighting and note tools, using the same colour all through may not portray the uniqueness of each text highlighted. Thus, the colour tool is used for colouring text and notes taken (see label 6.4 in Fig. 2). Moreso, the zoom tools increase/decrease the text view. All answers relating to problems encountered while using the MDA may be answered by clicking on the help tool. While working/reading through a document, you can, at any time, switch to other tabs or the main library, as shown in label 8 (with arrows pointing at the tabs). If you want to open a file with an external PDF reader, you will right-click on the document you wish to open. You can scroll through the popup and click on the task (in this case, click on open file externally). These are the features of the Mendeley Desktop application. Other features, such as opening the folder containing the file on your computer, deleting a document, etc.) are understandable while using the application.

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Figure 2. The reading interface of Mendeley desktop application



Importance of Mendeley Desktop Application

- *Easy Formatting of Citations and References*

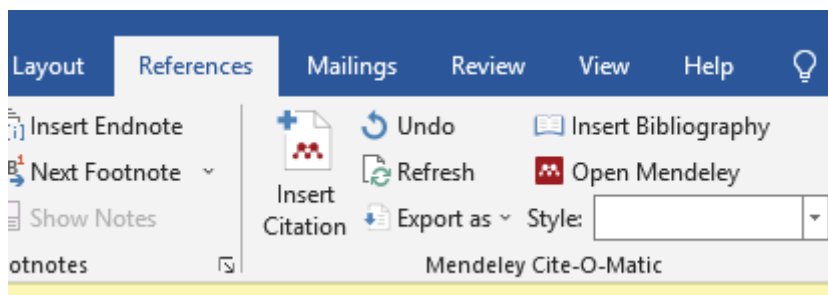
Apart from the MDA being used as a digital library, its primary strength is that it can be used to insert citations and references to documents. It has a word processor plugin in the tools tab (see labelled 1 in Fig 1). The plugin is accessible through the word processor itself and is compatible with MS Word and LibreOffice. In this chapter, only the MS-word plugin is described. The plugin can be found in the references tab in Microsoft Word 2013 or higher (Figure 3). The tools in the menu are; insert a citation, insert bibliography, style, refresh, undo, and export as. The insert citation tool is susceptible to every word. Thus, any word you type found in the library (Mendeley Desktop) would be identified. The authors' unique names and titles of documents in the document should be used to save time.

Words in the main body of the document are also tracked. This implies that a journal name, location of the research, or other words can be used. To eliminate errors, ensure that all documents are appropriately formatted with all relevant Metadata provided in Mendeley (using the box tagged number 4 in fig 1). Importantly, author(s) names should be arranged in the order of first to the last name. On the other hand, if the last name comes first, add a comma (,) before other names. The "Insert Bibliography" tool imports references of all the works cited through the Insert Citation tool. A preferred referencing style can be chosen using the "Style" tool.

- *Flexibility in Referencing Style*

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Figure 3. Mendeley desktop citations plugin in Microsoft word



Using the MDA and its plugin in a word processor has an advantage for authors. While formatting/preparing a book and research paper, authors often format papers without having a particular journal in mind. Before submission to a journal, the author(s) may be required to follow a formal template and article formatting guidelines requiring the authors to use specific referencing styles. In some cases, recommended styles may differ from those followed while drafting the manuscript. Using manual citation and referencing may require that author(s) begin formatting the citations and references to the new style recommended by the journal. This can be a tiring, time-consuming and herculean task. However, if citations and references were prepared using the Mendeley Desktop Program, a click of the button is all that is required to migrate from one referencing style to another. The Word Processor plugin has been programmed with many referencing styles (e.g., APA, Chicago, MLA etc.). This enables all authors who have used the plugin to cite works to change the referencing style with just a click easily. Another good thing about this application is that it always works with the most recent version of the referencing style. The application enables users to use citation styles not commonly used in a person's discipline, making it highly versatile and flexible to meet various needs. Usually, to use a new/unfamiliar citation or referencing style, one must spend a considerable amount of time learning it. Mendeley addresses all these concerns and makes writing faster.

- *Accessibility of Documents*

The MDA's interface allows its users to access their documents leisurely. Unlike PDF readers, where you will have to open a file before getting to know its Metadata, the MDA allows its users to access the Metadata of a document (e.g., Author(s), publisher, date of publication, abstract and so on) without having to read it. Synchronised documents in MD are stored in the cloud and can be accessed through the web version of Mendeley (Mendeley Web). One core strength of the application is its portability and easy migration of files from one computer to another. It is not easy to lose information indexed in MDA due to its cloud backup. A user can easily access his files on a new computer by simply signing in to his account on a new computer.

- *Staying Organised*

Scholars, researchers, and scientists can quickly note essential points in a document with the highlighting and annotation tools. This would help them draft detailed arguments and discussion points in

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their articles. Scholars often read documents but miss essential points due to poor organisation. On the contrary, using the MDA can enable scholars to highlight, quickly locate and remember the highlighted text to support their writing. Besides, the Mendeley Application records all downloaded materials related to a research project. Using keywords, authors can quickly locate essential materials against manual opening and closing of files or searching for materials from one folder to another. The Application also organises files by authors, publishers, year of publication, and other parameters. This can enable authors to navigate to their preferred documents with ease.

- *It eliminates the problem of poor citation/referencing*

Usually, well-written and crafted articles are rejected by prestigious journals due to poor referencing and citations. Issues such as citations without corresponding references and vice versa are commonplace among scholars and scientists. However, using the Mendeley application ensures that all works cited are listed in the bibliography or reference list and the other way around. This eliminates the problem of poor citations and references, increasing the chances of acceptance during submission for publication.

- *It is cost-effective*

In time past, many scholars have complained about losing quality materials in their libraries or computers due to different occurrences. These occurrences may include fire outbreaks, damage to a computer, stealing, etc. These materials are precious because huge sums were spent processing them. With the MDA, these issues are no longer common since most files must have been backed to the cloud. Therefore, Mendeley saves cost because authors do not have to spend resources to re-acquire data lost to the factors mentioned earlier. Furthermore, the use of the software is free and open to all interested individuals.

- *It saves time*

It is always very tedious to sit and prepare references to cited works manually. However, the time spent citing and listing references is minimal using the Mendeley application. This is because authors' information and article/document metadata are already stored in the database. Consequently, authors do not need to stress themselves writing down names and publication information. The use of the Mendeley Microsoft word plugin has a handy solution. All authors need to do is go to the references tab in the MS-Word, click on insert citation and enter a few keywords (authors name, or any word in the article title). Then, a list of files with such keywords will pop up for users to select their preferred document. Multiple author citation per idea is also supported.

- *Easy modification of citation/references*

Although the Mendeley application allows users to cite using different citation styles, the default style is the one that is applied when using the MS Word plugin. Nevertheless, authors can easily modify or edit citations to suit their needs. For instance, the Mendeley app, by default, will enter the citation in closed parentheses, such as those used when entering a citation at the end of an idea. It does not prepare citations in a narrative sense (to cite an idea and the cited author's name as part of the sentence). To adjust this, users seeking to use the narrative citation pattern must edit the parenthetical citation (which

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comes by default) to suit their needs. To achieve the narrative citation form, the users of Mendeley must modify the parenthetical citation. Interestingly, Mendeley allows for modifications without losing track of the metadata or referencing style.

MENDELEY: A DIGITAL LIBRARY FOR RESEARCHERS, SCIENTISTS AND SCHOLARS

The Mendeley can be regarded as a digital library because of its ability to store resources, promote remote access, provide metadata/bibliographic details, personalise suggestions for further reading, and offer selective information services. Like the traditional library, the MDA possess features that account for its library outlook. It has a user interface with high cataloguing capacity, which is one of the strengths of the traditional library. Documents are arranged based on metadata such as authors' names, the document's title, publishers, year of publication, and date added to the library. All documents are appropriately arranged based on file or subject by creating a specific folder and subfolder. All added books/documents can be read because of the PDF technology incorporated in the application. The folders/subfolders serve a similar purpose to a bookshelf in traditional libraries. Unless a document is deleted, all documents are intact in the MDA, like the traditional library where people may hijack documents. The MDA can be termed a "digital library" for scholars, researchers, and scientists with these features. Besides, one of its primary objectives is for the research bibliography. Thus, it is a library that best suits scholars, researchers and scientists. Even though these categories of persons widely use it, other people can also use it as a library since books and other documents can be saved and read through the application. Its portability, cloud linkages, easy sorting, and classification capacity make it more versatile than a traditional library.

Mendeley Versus a Traditional Library Compared

While Mendeley is considered a digital library, it is used to access only pdf and word documents. This implies that printed documents cannot be accessed through it. Of course, the name digital library already tells that only electronic documents (particularly pdf and word) can be accessed. In traditional libraries, documents in all forms of relevant collections are often available. All documents in different formats such as printed documents (e.g., books, journal articles etc.), calendars, pictures and other materials can be housed by the program. Electronic files such as videos and audio-video resources can also be in e-libraries (usually a section in traditional libraries).

An advantage of the Mendeley library to a traditional library is its mobility. The traditional library is often at a specific location unless relocated (which is very rare). Switching to a different document is an easy task in MDA, while the reverse is almost the case in traditional libraries. Unless for personal libraries, highlighting text while reading is usually impossible or not allowed in traditional libraries because what a reader may see as a critical point may not be seen by another reader as necessary. However, in the Mendeley Desktop, the reader can highlight as much as he wishes because the highlight can easily be erased. Furthermore, the Mendeley Desktop library is often owned by a single person by installing the application on a computer. Individuals own traditional libraries, teams, educational sectors, government etc.; traditional libraries can also support many users simultaneously.

A Digital Library for Researchers, Scientists, and Scholars**CONCLUSION**

The MDA is a free bibliography application for scholars, researchers, and scientists because of its essential features. The application saves time and provides standard bibliographies. Aside from scholars, researchers and scientists, the application is also helpful to all individuals capable of reading PDF and unprinted documents. It has a friendly user interface with a high cataloguing capacity. Thus, considered a digital library. This chapter has discussed the Mendeley application richly, along with its features and extensions (plugin). The importance of Mendeley is also discussed as its relationship with a traditional library. This chapter concludes that Mendeley can be used as a digital library in a traditional library but not the other way around. Whatever the strengths, the Mendeley Application can be a subset of a traditional library as both complements each other.

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KEY TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

Bibliography: A bibliography provides a list of works (such as books and articles) on a subject or by an author.

Catalogue: A catalogue is a list of all the books and other materials located in a particular library or collection of libraries.

Digital Library: This is an online database containing digital items such as text, still images, audio and video clips and other media formats. A digital library and its holdings are supported through Internet.

Documents: A document is a printed, illustrated, projected, or archived expression of ideas, which is often the embodiment of both non-fictional and fictitious material.

Electronic Database: An electronic database is a computer-based accumulation or directory of materials, such as research papers, review articles, theses, books, and chapters in books, among others, that are structured logically with searchable features or sections.

Information: Information are verified or process data about events, observations, things, procedures, people, processes, or phenomena that can lend itself to meaningful conclusions.

A Digital Library for Researchers, Scientists, and Scholars

Researchers: Researchers are individuals concerned with discovering new knowledge by engaging in the systematic gathering of data, processing them into information using appropriate analytic procedures and making meaning from the evidence for man's improved existence.

Scholars: Scholars are people with a profound knowledge of a subject, an area, or a discipline. Scholars engage in academic or intellectual endeavours and use their intellectual curiosity to become specialists in their professions.

Scientists: Scientists are people that meticulously collect and analyse data and evidence for the generation and testing of hypotheses to gain and share insight and knowledge.

Shelf: A shelf is a rectangular piece of wooden or other hard substance attached to a wall or incorporated into furniture that serves as a platform for storing or displaying library materials.